

AVADHOOTA DATTA PEETHAM - A HAVEN FOR ALL CREEDS

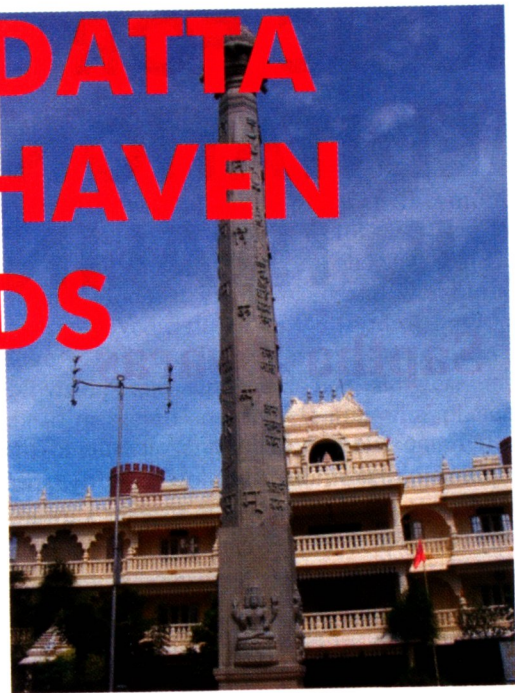
BOY Satyanarayana's modest home lay in a secluded little village near Kanakapura but the ashram he built in Mysore, the royal city of world renown, is anything but secluded. One common feature is the aura of serenity that both places exude, one by its location in the lap of unspoilt nature and the other by the presence of a colossus of a spiritual leader and unusual healer, His Holiness Sri Ganapati Sachchidananda Swamiji. His ashram known by the name of Avadhoota Datta Peetham is verily an haven of calm, harmony and spiritualism.

The sprawling ashram grounds are studded with several architectural gems and delightful landscape features, like the unique Sumeru Dhyana Mantapam, the spacious, modern Nada Mantapa, the Vishwam Museum and the Kishkinda Bonsai Garden. This Bonsai garden, largest in India has many Bonsai trees, some of which are being grown for their Medicinal value. Vishwam is a three floor Museum, housing rare and impressive gifts received by Datta Peetham during the past three decades.

The ornate and highly aesthetic Hanumadwaram welcomes all visitors into the premises of Datta Peetham. A depiction of Lord Dattatreya as an infant is a striking feature inside the welcome arch.

The chimes of temple bells, strains of enchanting music or the chant of Vedic hymns reach the ears of the visitor who steps past the arch into the ashram for, a school for imparting training in the Vedas, and the Universal prayer Hall, with motifs representing the values of different faiths and a marble Dattatreya Temple, the first of the 30 odd Dattatreya Temples established by Poojya Sri Swamiji in India and abroad. Coaching in Sanskrit studies is also imparted here.

The very first unusual structure, the Sumeru Dhyana Mantap with its pyramid shaped dome lies next to the Karyalaya. The design of the mantap ensures that anyone entering it instantly reaches a state of calm and serenity.

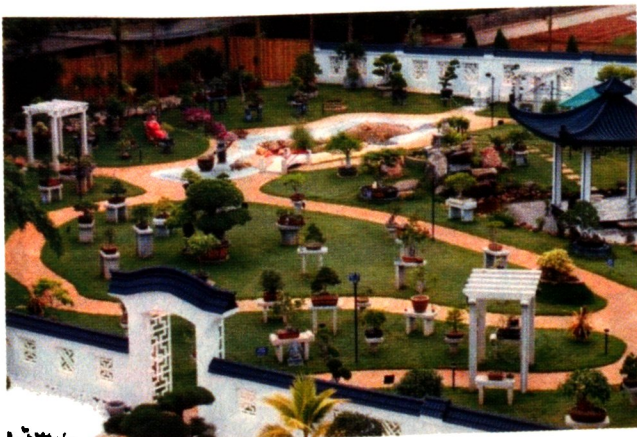


The towering terra cotta sculpture of Moolikeswara, and the tall lamp shaped Akala Mrithyu Moksha Stupam catch the eye next, for their unusual concept and execution. The first represents the Lord of Herbs and aptly overlooks a garden full of herbs and plants that possess medicinal qualities. The stupam symbolizes the craving of the soul to break free from its earthly moorings.

Of similar magnitude is the 60-foot tall Dharma Dhwaaja, a stone pillar near the prayer hall. A 40 minutes sound & light show held during week ends speaks on the concept of Dharma.

Nada Mantapa with its dazzling Sapta Swara Devata Temple representing the seven basic musical notes is a 35,000 square-foot structure and has been the venue for concerts by renowned musicians from the far corners of the country and the world. The sprawling Balaji Mandir Complex, in the Datta Venkateshwara Kshetram, is revered as mini Tirupati by the thousands of devotees who visit the shrine. The ashram has a Datta Venkata Agama Vidya Kendra for priest training and Temple management and the Sri Ganapati Sachchidananda Vidya Samsthe that runs educational institutions. Two rehabilitation centres, one for the communication impaired and another for women in distress are located at Bangalore and Hyderabad respectively. A holistic health centre offers health care services covering Allopathy, Homoeopathy and Ayurveda systems of medicine, as well as music, Yoga and other forms of therapy. The centre-piece of the ashram is of course the Sri Chakra Meru where His Holiness Sri Swamiji conducts Sri Chakra Pooja which entralls the devotees who congregate in large numbers to witness it with boundless joy.

Sri Swamiji and the ashram ensure that the visitor does not go hungry during his visit. The free 'Annadaana Seva' by the Jayalakshmi Matha Annadana Trust feeds thousands of visitors every day.



ALL INDIA BONSAI CONVENTION & EXHIBITION - 2007

Datta Peetham is hosting the "All India Bonsai convention & Exhibition in Mysore Ashram from 24-26 November 2007. Internationally renowned Bonsai Masters will lead the convention.